

Stayman and Jacoby Transfers

The Stayman convention is used to find a 4-4 Major suit fit after one partner has opened 1NT or 2NT. Responder bids an artificial 2♣ and the Notrump bidder then bids a 4-card Major if she has one, or 2 or 3 ♦ otherwise.

The Jacoby Transfer convention is used to uncover a 5-3 Major suit fit after one partner has opened 1NT or 2NT. A response of ♦s asks opener to bid ♥s, a response of ♥s asks opener to bid ♠s.

The two conventions complement each other, that's why they are together in this set of practices.

Board: 1
Dealer: **North**
Contract: 4♥
Declarer: North
Lead: ♦J

Board: 2
Dealer: **East**
Contract: 4♠
Declarer: East
Lead: ♥5

Board: 3
Dealer: **South**
Contract: 4♠
Declarer: South
Lead: ♣K

Board: 4
Dealer: **West**
Contract: 4♠
Declarer: West
Lead: ♦Q

Board: 5
Dealer: **North**
Contract: 6♥
Declarer: North
Lead: ♣10

Board: 6
Dealer: **East**
Contract: 2NT
Declarer: East
Lead: ♣4

Board 1

North Deals

None Vul

♠ J 10 9 8

♥ 5 3

♦ K Q 4 2

♣ 6 5 2

♠ Q 6 3

♥ Q 10 9 2

♦ A 7 6

♣ A K 3



♠ 5 4

♥ K 7 4

♦ J 10 9 8

♣ Q J 9 7

♠ A K 7 2

♥ A J 8 6

♦ 5 3

♣ 10 8 4

SOUTH has four cards in each Major suit - this is an ideal situation for Stayman.

NORTH shows a ♥ suit and SOUTH immediately bids game in that suit.

*West**North**East**South*

1NT

Pass

2♣

Pass

2♥

Pass

4♥

All Pass

4♥ by North

Lead: ♦ J

Board 2

East Deals

N-S Vul

♠ K 9 7 4

♥ K 8 6 2

♦ 7 3

♣ 8 6 5

♠ 10 5 3

♥ J 9 4

♦ Q J 9 4

♣ J 9 3



♠ A Q 8 2

♥ A Q 3

♦ K 10 6 2

♣ A Q

♠ J 6

♥ 10 7 5

♦ A 8 5

♣ K 10 7 4 2

Stayman convention works just fine after a 2NT opening, just at a higher level.

WEST knows that 6 points will be enough for game opposite EAST's 20-21, she just needs to find out if there is a 4-4 Major suit fit. There is, in ♠s.

*West**North**East**South*

3 ♣

Pass

3 ♠

Pass

4 ♠

All Pass

4 ♠ by East

Lead: ♥ 5

Board 3

South Deals

E-W Vul

♠ K 3
 ♥ Q 6 5 2
 ♦ K 9 4 3
 ♣ K Q 7

♠ Q 9 8 7 4
 ♥ A J 10 8 3
 ♦ Q 6
 ♣ 5



♠ 6 5 2
 ♥ 7 4
 ♦ J 10 5
 ♣ J 8 4 3 2

♠ A J 10
 ♥ K 9
 ♦ A 8 7 2
 ♣ A 10 9 6

NORTH has five cards in each Major and SOUTH opens 1NT.

First NORTH bids 2♥, indicating a 5-card ♠ suit with the Transfer bid. Then, after SOUTH bids the obligatory 2♠, NORTH jumps to 4♥, promising enough strength for game, and also five ♥s to go with the five ♠s.

SOUTH prefers ♠s, so she corrects the contract to 4♠.

West	North	East	South
			1NT
Pass	2♥	Pass	2♠
Pass	4♥	Pass	4♠
All Pass			
4♠ by South			
Lead: ♣K			

Board 4

West Deals

Both Vul

♠ A 9 6
 ♥ K Q 6 2
 ♦ K 5 3 2
 ♣ K 8

♠ J 10 8 7
 ♥ A 9 4
 ♦ Q J 6
 ♣ 10 5 2

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ K Q 5 4 2
 ♥ 8 7
 ♦ A 8
 ♣ Q 7 6 4

♠ 3
 ♥ J 10 5 3
 ♦ 10 9 7 4
 ♣ A J 9 3

West	North	East	South
1NT	Pass	2♥	Pass
2♠	Pass	3NT	Pass
4♠			
All Pass			
4♠ by West			
Lead: ♦ Q			

With 12 points and five ♠s, when EAST hears her partner open 1NT she knows there is a game - either 3NT or 4♠.

EAST first transfers WEST to ♠s, then jumps to 3NT, giving WEST the choice.

WEST has three ♠s, so he chooses 4♠, taking the 8-card Major fit.

Board 5

North Deals

None Vul

♠ J 10 9 5 3

♥ 8

♦ J 10 7 3

♣ Q 7 3

♠ K 8 6

♥ A 9 3

♦ K Q 8

♣ A K J 2



♠ A Q 2

♥ 10 6

♦ 6 5 4

♣ 10 8 6 5 4

♠ 7 4

♥ K Q J 7 5 4 2

♦ A 9 2

♣ 9

After NORTH opens 2NT, SOUTH is pretty sure there will be a slam in ♥s. But, the contract should be played from the NORTH side so the opening lead doesn't go through any vulnerable ♠ holding NORTH might have.

SOUTH transfers NORTH to ♥s, then uses Blackwood to be sure they aren't off two Aces. Missing one Ace he settles for 6♥.

<i>West</i>	<i>North</i>	<i>East</i>	<i>South</i>
	2NT	Pass	3♦
Pass	3♥	Pass	4NT
Pass	5♥	Pass	6♥
All Pass			
6♥ by North			
Lead: ♣10			

Board 6

East Deals

E-W Vul

♠ K 9 8 5

♥ Q 7

♦ K 8 7

♣ J 9 6 5

♠ Q 7 4 3

♥ A 9 4

♦ Q 9 3

♣ A Q 3



♠ A 6

♥ K J 5 3

♦ A 6 5 4

♣ K 10 7

♠ J 10 2

♥ 10 8 6 2

♦ J 10 2

♣ 8 4 2

WEST has an invitational hand, (9 points), after EAST's 1NT opening. With a 4-card ♠ suit she uses Stayman.

EAST then shows his 4-card ♥ suit.

With no ♥ fit, WEST can only invite with 2NT, an invitation which EAST declines.

*West**North**East**South*

2♣

Pass

2♥

Pass

2NT

All Pass

2NT by East

Lead: ♣4